Young Lives (YL)
Round 7

Prof. Tassew Woldehanna (Principal Investigator, Addis Ababa University and Policy Studies Institute)

Dr. Alula Pankhurst (Country Director, Young Lives Ethiopia)

Dr. Marta Favara (Director of Research, University of Oxford)

Funded by: FCDO

INFORMED CONSENT

YOUNGER COHORT

You and your family have participated in the Young Lives study since you were approximately one year old. Along this time, we have visited you or talked to you over the phone on several occasions.

This time, we are starting a new round of the Young Lives study. We come to provide you with all the necessary information and kindly request your consent to remain as a volunteer participant.

Who are we?

As you know, we are *Young Lives* workers, a study run in our country by the *Policy Studies Institute* (PSI), Young Lives Ethiopia, and the University of Oxford.

What do we want to know? Purpose of the study

Since 2002, Young Lives has followed a group of children that grew up in four different countries, including Ethiopia, to learn about various aspects of their lives and their families. The purpose of this round is to visit all participants and their households so that they continue to provide us with information that allows us to make their reality known to government authorities, here and around the world. The information shared also helps to identify strategies that contribute to improving the living conditions of young people like you in Ethiopia and other similar countries.

We will provide you and explain to you all the information, as well as address all your questions and concerns so you can freely decide if you accept to participate in the interview and give us your consent.

What will we do?

If you consent to remain as a volunteer participant, we will do the following:

1. We will be using a tablet to record the information you provide. To keep your contact details updated, we will update your personal details, location, mobile number, email, etc.

2. We will ask questions about your household composition, marital status, the socioeconomic level of your household, events that might have affected the economy of your household, and access to food and social programmes.

3. As we have done in previous visits and calls, we will ask you about your education, health, time use, movement history, labor activities, emotional wellbeing, mental health, and your views and opinions on different aspects of life. On this occasion we will ask about your willingness to take risks and preferences about time; trust in others; your thoughts about migration plans; your opinion about certain aspects of what makes a good job; and your experiences during the conflict involving the Ethiopian government and the Tigray People's Liberation Front.

4. The survey also includes questions on more sensitive topics, such as the consumption of cigarettes, alcohol, and drugs; sexual and reproductive health; experiences of violence; and your attitudes towards sexual identity. You will be asked to answer these questions by yourself, listening to them using a tablet. The information you provide will be confidential; the enumerator will not be able to see your answers. You do not have to answer these questions if you do not wish to (nor any of the other questions).

5. We will also ask you to complete a short reading activity and two short computerized tasks, very similar to ones you have done before.

6. We will measure your weight, height, and abdominal circumference.

7. If you have children, we will ask some questions about their birth and health.

In addition to participating in the main survey, we would also like invite you to be part of the “stress study” but we will tell you more about this at the end.

Who will know my identity and my families’ identity?

All the information we have collected in the past and will collect now will be treated in the strictest confidence. We will not reveal your name or the name of your family members, or name of the town you live in, to anyone who is not a member of the study team.

Under no circumstances will your names or any data that can identify you be disclosed

What will we do with the information we have collected?

It will be used to produce reports and scientific publications, which will be made available to government authorities, and stored in an anonymous database for other researchers to consult, with the aim of maximizing the use of the lessons learned and to benefit future generations.

We might use your contact information and identity to understand better your access to public services and the characteristics of the place where you are living but all the information will be anonymized and in no circumstances, we will disclose your identity, name and location.

Is there any risk in taking part in this study?

There is no risk for you nor your family for taking part in this study.

Which benefits you and your family would get from participating in this study?

- Your participation is very important, because all the information you give us, along with the information other young people who participate will provide, will help us understand those factors that are more important for young people.

- The measurement of your weight, height and BMI allows us to measure your nutritional status and see if you are at risk of being underweight or overweight. According to the results, we will point you to the designated section in the consultation guide where you can find nutritional advice and recommendations.

- Also, we can point you to the designated section in the consultation guide where you will find more information and support on mental health and wellbeing as you need it.

- We will give you a financial compensation of 500 Birr for your time. This is almost double what we gave you in past to account for the price rise and also because of the extra effort on the self-administered questionnaire and the stress study.

How long the study is going to take?

The interview and related activities will take about three hours, and you will need about 40 minutes to complete the self-administered questionnaire and the reading activity as well as the tasks on the tablet. Depending on your availability and to reduce fatigue, the interview and related activities might be carried out in more than one visit.

What happens if you decide not to be part of this study?

You are completely free to decide whether or not to continue participating in the study. You are free to change your mind at any time, without affecting your participation in other programs or studies in health, education, development or the fight against poverty. In addition, if you participate, you are free to decline to answer any question or section of the interview, and to finish the interview at any time you like.

Where can I obtain more information if I need it?

At any time, if you would like to ask any questions regarding this study, if you would like to withdraw from the study, or if you would like to inform us of any change of address or telephone number, you can contact Professor Tassew Woldehanna (Safeguarding Lead, Young Lives Ethiopia) or Chanie Ejigu.

This project has been reviewed by the College of Education and Behavioral Studies of Addis Ababa University, the National Research Ethical Review Committee at the Ministry of Education, and the Departmental Research Ethics Committee, Oxford Department of International Development, University of Oxford (UK), and it has been given a favourable opinion for conduct.

A copy of this form will stay with you for your files.

Do you agree to participate in this study?

No [ ] Main reason: _____

Yes [ ]

- **Answering the survey?**

  No [ ] Main reason: _____

  Yes [ ]

- **Answering the self-administered questionnaire?**

No [ ] Main reason: _____

Yes [ ]

- **Completing a short reading activity?**

No [ ] Main reason: _____

Yes [ ]

- **Completing two short games on the tablet?**

No [ ] Main reason: _____

Yes [ ]

CONSENT

[FIELDWORKER: Please, record the respondent's consent to each survey components and sign the consent on behalf of them]

As a fieldworker signing this Informed Consent Form, I declare that in the presence of a witness: I have explained in detail all the aspects of this study, including its objectives, the duration and procedures to be performed, the risks and benefits, as well as the confidentiality of the information and all the aspects described in this format to the young person identified above, and that he / she has completely and voluntarily accepted their participation in the study. All questions asked have been answered satisfactorily. As a sign of compliance, I sign this form. * Likewise, in the presence of the witness, the young person was given a copy of this consent for his / her files

_____ _____

Fieldworker's full name **Fieldworker's signature**

DATE: __ __ / __ __ / 2 0 2 __

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CONSENT FOR HAIR SAMPLE COLLECTON (STRESS STUDY)

YOUNGER COHORT

As I mentioned at the beginning and in the main consent form, we are inviting all the young people who are participating in the Young Lives study to be part of the "stress study". For this, we would like to ask you to provide a small hair sample, smaller than the quantity of hair you normally lose when brushing it.

[**ENUMERATOR**: *show the hair sample/card*]

The lock of hair we need is about 1.5cm in diameter. The hair sample collected will be subsequently analyzed in a laboratory to get a measure of the level of the cortisol hormone in your body. The cortisol hormone is important because it increases in response to and helps our body deal with situations, positive or negative, that cause a feeling of emotional, physical or psychological tension (for example when experiencing an earthquake or winning the lottery). Eventually the increase of the hormone cortisol in our body disappears, but it remains in our hair, this is why we ask you for this sample. We will test if cortisol levels relate to life experiences and/or to current physical and psycho-emotional health. If you choose to participate, this should take less than 5 minutes, is completely painless, and will not have any repercussion on the re-growing of your hair. We will use scissors to collect the sample from the back of the head, so it will not be visible, but covered by the rest of your hair.

[**ENUMERATOR**: *if the respondent is hesitant or is not inclined to take part, please show them the example video of the hair sample collection*]

As for the rest of the study, your hair sample will be identified by an anonymised code to protect your identity.

We know that this is asking more of you than we did when we came to visit you previously. This is one reason why we have decided to give you a financial compensation of 500 Birr at the end of this interview, which is almost double what we gave you in the past, to acknowledge your extra effort.

- **Do you agree to provide a small lock of hair?**

No [ ] Main reason: _____

Yes [ ]

[FIELDWORKER: Please, record the respondent's consent and sign the consent on behalf of them/. The consent should be asked to everyone, even to those who do not look like eligible because having to short hairs]

As a fieldworker signing this Informed Consent Form, I declare that in the presence of a witness: I have explained in detail all the aspects of this study, including its objectives, the duration and procedures to be performed, the risks and benefits, as well as the confidentiality of the information and all the aspects described in this format to the young person identified above, and that he / she has completely and voluntarily accepted their participation in the study. All questions asked have been answered satisfactorily. As a sign of compliance, I sign this form. * Likewise, in the presence of the witness, the young person was given a copy of this consent for his / her files

_____ _____

Fieldworker's full name **Fieldworker's signature**

DATE: __ __ / __ __ / 2 0 2 __